appendix A. Preparing your development environment

For .NET developers in a Windows-centric world, Visual Studio was pretty much a developer requirement in the past. But with .NET and ASP.NET Core going cross-platform, that's no longer the case.

All of ASP.NET Core (creating new projects, building, testing, and publishing) can be run from the command line for any supported operating system. All you need is the .NET software development kit (SDK), which provides the .NET command-line interface (CLI). Alternatively, if you're using Windows and not comfortable with the command line, you can choose **File** > **New** > **Project** in Visual Studio to dive straight in. With ASP.NET Core, it's all about choice!

In a similar vein, you can now get a great editing experience outside Visual Studio thanks to the OmniSharp (www.omnisharp.net) project. This is an open-source set of libraries and editor plugins that provide code suggestions and autocomplete (IntelliSense) across a wide range of editors and operating systems. How you set up your environment will likely depend on which operating system you're using and what you're used to.

Remember that for .NET 7, the operating system you choose for development has no bearing on the final systems you can run on. Whether you choose Windows, macOS, or Linux for development, you can deploy to any supported system.

In this appendix I'll show you how to install the .NET SDK so you can build, run, and publish .NET apps. I'll also discuss some of the integrated